Markup Language. Further rules are covered in the following sections, which examine specific scenarios in which Razor syntax is used, starting with how to add directives and code blocks to Razor pages.

3.1.1 Directives and code blocks

Let's start by taking another look at the code you used to calculate the part of the day in the previous chapter to see how Razor syntax is used to include server side C# code within the Razor page. The example in listing 3.1 demonstrates three facets of Razor syntax: how to include directives within the page, how to include standalone blocks of C# code, and how to include the result of C# expressions or the value of variables in the rendered HTML.

Listing 3.1 Reviewing Razor syntax in the Welcome page

```
@page                                                                    ❶
@model WebApplication1.Pages.WelcomeModel                                ❶
@{                                                                       ❷
    ViewData["Title"] = "Welcome!";                                      ❷

    var partOfDay = "morning";                                           ❷
    if(DateTime.Now.Hour > 12){                                          ❷
        partOfDay = "afternoon";                                         ❷
    }                                                                    ❷
    if(DateTime.Now.Hour > 18){                                          ❷
        partOfDay = "evening";                                           ❷
    }                                                                    ❷
}                                                                        ❷
<h1>Welcome</h1>
<p>It is @partOfDay on @DateTime.Now.ToString("dddd, dd MMMM")</p>      ❸
```

❶ Directives

❷ A C# code block

❸ C# inline expressions rendered as part of the output

The first instance of the @ symbol in this example demonstrates how directives are added to a page. *Directives* are C# expressions that start with the @ symbol followed by a reserved word (e.g., *page* or *model*) and enable functionality within